

Intranatal Care.....

- ◆ Care of a woman in all stages of labour is known as Intranatal care.

Normal labour.....

- ◆ “Spontaneous in onset, low-risk at the start of **labour** and remaining so throughout **labour** and delivery. The infant is born spontaneously in the vertex position between 37 and 42 completed weeks of pregnancy – **WHO**
- ◆ Normal labour is also known as **eutocia**

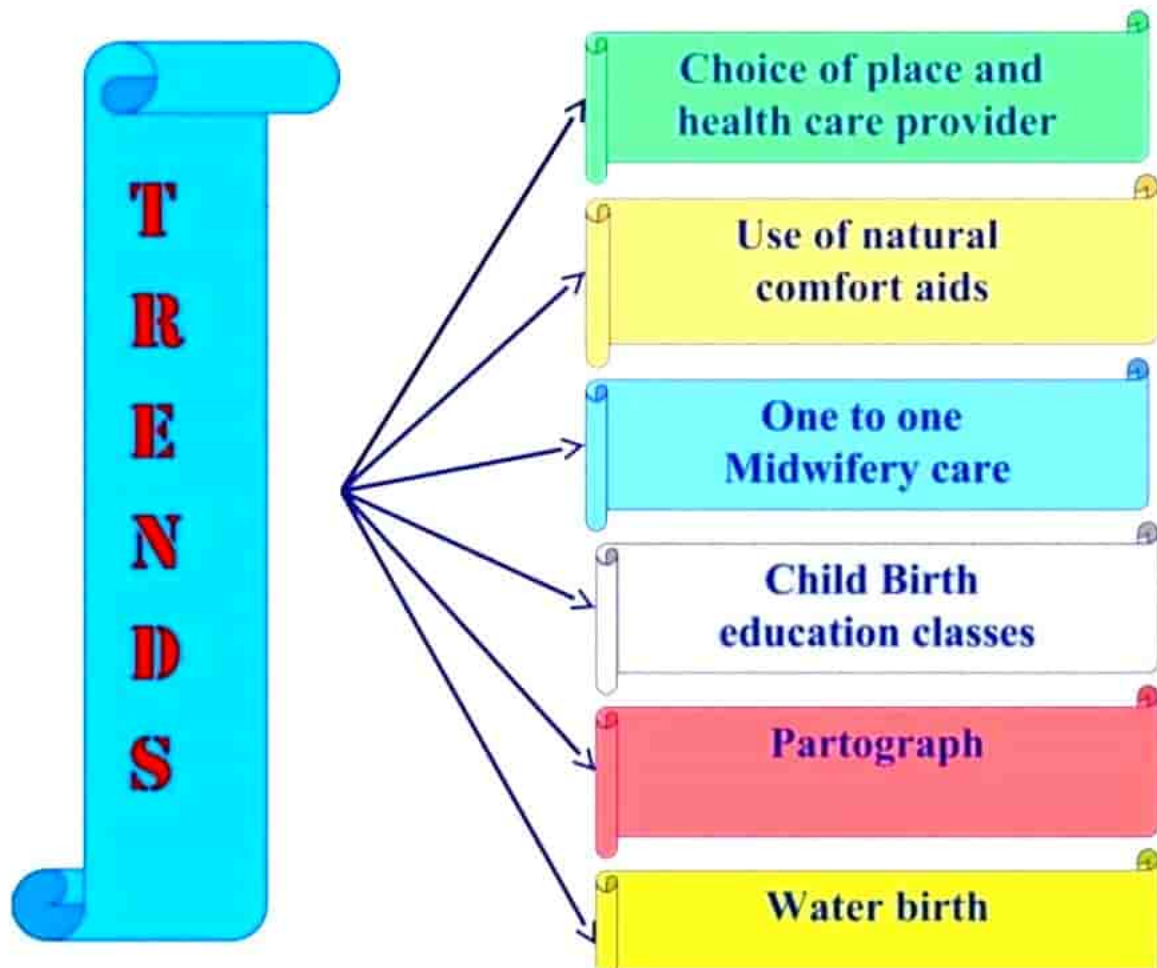
Some facts.....

Every Minute in the world.....

- ◆ 390 women become pregnant....
- ◆ 110 women experience pregnancy related complications.....
- ◆ 40 women have unsafe abortion....
- ◆ One woman die from pregnancy related complication.....

Stages of labour

- ◆ **First Stage** – starts with onset of regular uterine contraction and ends with full cervical effacement and dilatation.
- ◆ **Second Stage** – from full dilatation till delivery of fetus
- ◆ **Third Stage** – delivery of placenta



SCIENTIFIC BASE

INTRANATAL CARE

Breathing and Relaxation

- ◆ Breathing – deep and slow paced breathing helps in minimising the pain
- ◆ Relaxation -relaxation by using music and guided imagery will help in reduction of pain



Evidence....

- ◆ Modified paced breathing blocks more painful stimuli than the normal breathing (Nichols & Humenick 2000; Shapiro et al 1997)
- ◆ Choosing the subject for imagery and practicing the technique will enhance the effectiveness in progression of labour (Hoffart & Pross Keene, 1998)

Hydrotherapy & Effleurage

- ◆ Hydrotherapy – Bathing, Showering and Whirlpool baths with warm water is more helpful.
- ◆ Effleurage and counter pressure – light massage will help in minimising the pain.



Evidence.....

- ◆ Whirlpool baths in labour have positive effects on analgesia requirements and personal satisfaction with labour.
(Simkim & O'Hara, 2002)
- ◆ Effleurage and counter pressure applied bilaterally to the hips or knees will reduce low back pain (Simkim & Ancheta, 2010)

Ambulation and Positions



- ◆ Ambulation enhances the uterine activity and distract the woman from the discomfort



- ◆ Different positions used in first stage will speed up the labour process



Evidence.....

- ◆ Maternal ambulation in first stage of labour decreases the duration of first stage. (Robert CL & Albert CS, 2006)
- ◆ Maintaining upright position in first stage will reduce the duration of first stage. (Kumud, Avinash & Seema 2013)

Birthing balls

- ◆ It is a large air filled rubber ball (60 Cm in diameter) made up of extra tough non slip burst proof, that is easily wiped and clean. The woman will be sitting over or leaning on a birthing ball after 2cm of dilatation for 15 minutes



Evidence.....

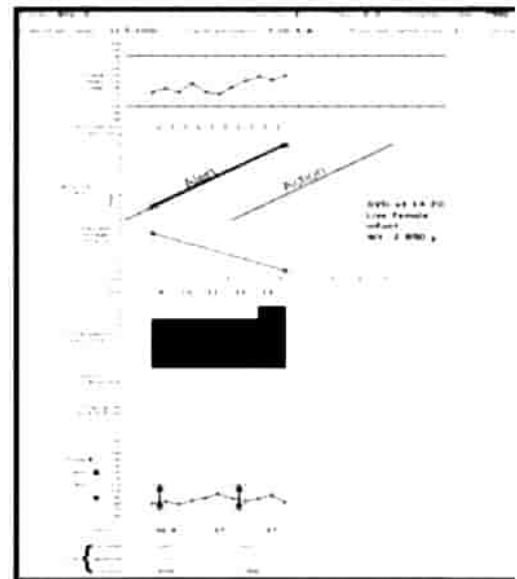
- ◆ Use of birthing ball in first stage of labour will reduce the pain. (Msid D'ecosta, 2013)
- ◆ Use of birthing ball is effective in reducing labour pain perception and improves the coping level. (Dr. Lata Venkateshen, 2012)

Evidence.....

- ◆ Randomized Control Trail on 60 primiparous women shown mean pain scores in birth ball group were significantly lower than the mean pain scores in the control group (Taavoni et. al, 2011)

Partograph

- ◆ Partograph is a chart in which the salient features of labour are entered in a graphic form and it provides the opportunity for early identification of deviations from normal.



Who should plot WHO

Partograph and How?

Ideally only one health worker should be entering the information until the patient delivers.

Patient should be examined serially at specific intervals by the same observer for recording different parameters



Water Birthing

- ◆ It is a process of giving birth in a tub of warm water
- ◆ Heat as a non pharmacological method of pain relief helps in reducing the pain intensity and increases the pain consistency.



Evidence

- ◆ Compared the water birth and land birth and showed that patients in the water birth group needed less obstetrical analgesia and warm water reduced the pain in 69% of the women (Geissbuehler et al (2004))

Active management of III stage labour

- ◆ Active management of the third stage of labor (AMTSL) includes three steps:
- ◆ Administration of a uterotonic drug (oxytocin, 10 IU injection, is the drug of choice)
- ◆ Controlled cord traction
- ◆ Uterine massage after delivery of placenta

Helping babies breathe

- ◆ The Golden Minute®
- ◆ Helping Babies Breathe emphasizes skilled attendants at birth, assessment of every baby, temperature support, stimulation to breathe, and assisted ventilation as needed, all within "The Golden Minute" after birth.

Barriers

1. Lack of reinforcement for performance
2. Perverse incentive payment system
3. Limited reliance on EBP
4. Lack of core child bearing knowledge
5. Cost
6. Limitation of views put forth in media
7. Chances of malpractice